

TL;DR – User-Behaviour Analysis Summary

This one-pager distills the key findings from the detailed Hotjar session analysis into high-level insights and actionable next steps.

Snapshot of the data

- **5 162 sessions** recorded between June–July 2025. Nearly **99 %** were first-time visitors.
- Devices: **Desktop ≈ 54 %**, **Mobile ≈ 44 %**, **Tablet ≈ 2 %**.
- Median session: **80 s**, **39 interactions**, **9 pages**.
- Core behaviour fields include **U-turns** (users navigate to a page then immediately return) and **rage clicks** (repeated clicks on the same element). U-turns were present in **~9 %** of sessions; rage clicks were very rare (two sessions) but indicated severe frustration ¹ ² .

Top insights

- **Mobile friction:** Mobile users performed **60 % more actions** and viewed **~14 pages** per session versus **7 – 8 pages** on desktop. They also accounted for **75 %** of U-turns. The mobile flow requires more effort, suggesting it is harder to navigate or complete forms.
- **Navigation confusion:** U-turns concentrated on the **match** page and related form steps. Behaviour-analytics literature explains that U-turns occur when a user clicks a link then immediately goes back because they are lost or the link is mis-labelled ¹ ³ .
- **Question clarity:** Over **430 sessions** triggered a “why we ask” tooltip, implying that many users are unsure why certain questions are asked.
- **Retention challenge:** Only **69 sessions** were from returning users—indicating that most visitors never come back after submitting the form.
- **Rage-click evidence:** Two outlier sessions showed very long durations (>800 s) and repeated clicks. Even though rare, rage clicks signal broken or confusing elements causing intense frustration ² .

Immediate fixes

1. **Fix navigation on the match page:** Audit the page and upstream links; mis-labelled or broken links are likely behind U-turns. Cleaning up navigation should directly reduce U-turn frequency. ¹
2. **Resolve broken UI elements:** Use session replays to identify elements behind the two rage-click sessions and fix any technical or layout issues. ²
3. **Streamline mobile forms:** Simplify multi-step forms and reduce scrolling to lower the burden on mobile users. Use larger touch targets and progress indicators.
4. **Clarify questions up front:** Provide concise, inline explanations for why personal questions are necessary so users do not need to expand tool-tips.

Strategic opportunities

- **Introduce progress bars/breadcrumbs:** Giving users a sense of progress may reduce back-tracking and U-turns. ³
- **Run exit-intent surveys:** Collect feedback from users who leave the flow to understand reasons for abandonment and inform iterative improvements. ⁴
- **Invest in retention:** Provide follow-up content or the ability to save progress and return later to encourage returning visits.
- **Regularly test with users:** Continuous usability testing and session-replay reviews will surface hidden issues before they impact conversions.

Bottom line

Reducing navigation confusion and simplifying the mobile experience are the quickest paths to improving user satisfaction and conversion. Once the critical fixes are in place, iterate on clarity and retention features to build long-term trust and loyalty.

¹ 13 Behavior Analytics Metrics To Track + Analyze
<https://contentsquare.com/guides/behavior-analytics/metrics/>

² How to Use Rage Clicks To Improve User Experience
<https://www.hotjar.com/blog/rage-clicks/>

³ 10 Ways Hotjar Can Help Improve UX
<https://www.hotjar.com/blog/hotjar-to-improve-ux/>

⁴ Why Are Users Dropping Off Your Website?
<https://www.hotjar.com/blog/website-users-drop-off/>

User Behavior Analysis Report

Data structure examination

The uploaded CSV contains **5162** session-level observations recorded through Hotjar session replays. Each row represents a single user session and includes the following important fields:

Field	Description
Recording URL	Link to the Hotjar session replay.
Publicly Shared/ Already Watched	Booleans indicating whether the recording has been shared or viewed internally.
Created	Timestamp of the session (we converted this to a date for analysis).
New / Returning	Categorical field indicating whether the session was from a first-time or returning user.
Hotjar User ID	Unique identifier for each visitor.
Country	Country derived from the IP address (US dominates the dataset).
Action Count	Total number of user interactions (clicks, scrolls, etc.).
Page Count	Number of pages visited in the session.
Duration (seconds)	Session length.
Device / Device Screen Size	Device type (Desktop, Phone, Tablet) and screen category.
Browser / Operating System	Client environment.
Referrer, Landing Page, Exit Page	URLs for entry and exit pages; useful for understanding where users arrive and drop off.
Rage Clicks	Count of rage-click events captured by Hotjar. Rage clicks occur when users repeatedly click an element in a short period, often indicating frustration 【4426695295446†L64-L85】.
U-Turns	Count of U-turn events. A U-turn happens when a user navigates to a page and immediately returns to the previous page, typically because they are lost or the link is mislabelled 【521379504566290†L513-L518】.

Field	Description
Events	Comma-separated list of custom events triggered during the session (e.g., publisher, question, why_we_ask_expanded, trigger-nps-survey).

Several fields such as **Comments**, **Labels**, **Incoming Feedback** and **Net Promoter Score** are empty in this dataset, so they were excluded from the analysis.

Key insights

1. Behavioural patterns

Device and user type distribution. The majority of sessions were initiated by **new users** (98.7% of sessions) with only 69 sessions from returning users. Devices are split between **Desktop** (2 795 sessions) and **Phones** (2 282 sessions), with a small number of **Tablets** (85 sessions). The desktop users have shorter sessions on average—about **39 actions**, **7.5 pages** and **147 s** per session—while phone and tablet users perform **64–73 actions**, visit **14–16 pages** and spend **221–318 s** per session. The longer and more interaction-heavy sessions on mobile suggest the current experience requires more effort from mobile users.

Session length and engagement. Across all sessions, the median session lasted **80 s** and involved **39 actions** across **9 pages**. There is, however, a long-tail distribution: some sessions lasted over **3 000 s** and recorded more than **1 300 interactions**, suggesting a subset of highly engaged or potentially frustrated users.

U-turn behaviour. U-turns occurred in **9 %** of sessions (about **464 sessions**). On average, sessions containing U-turns had **75 actions**, visited **17 pages** and lasted **222 s**, compared with **48 actions**, **10 pages** and **178 s** for sessions without U-turns. U-turns are more frequent on **mobile**; phone sessions generated **418 U-turns** versus **138** on desktop. According to behaviour-analytics research, U-turns occur when users click through to a page and immediately return because they cannot find what they need—often due to poorly labelled menus or broken links [521379504566290†L513-L518] . Hotjar’s documentation also notes that U-turns are a strong signal that users are lost or confused [591676217478393†L302-L307] .

Rage clicks. Rage-click events were extremely rare—only **four events** across the entire dataset (two sessions). Those sessions averaged **216 actions**, **26 pages** and **887 s**, far above the typical session. Hotjar’s guidance notes that repeated clicking in the same area signals user frustration and is usually caused by poor page speed, confusion or broken elements [4426695295446†L64-L85] . Even though the sample is tiny, the extreme length and interaction count of these sessions suggest a severe user-experience issue when rage clicks occur.

Event usage. The **Events** column contained only four types of custom events: publisher, question, why_we_ask_expanded and trigger-nps-survey. The vast majority ($\approx 8\,550$ occurrences) were publisher events used to flag the referring publisher (e.g., Forbes). More than **430** sessions triggered the why_we_ask_expanded event, indicating that users frequently clicked to see explanations for the

questions in the form. Relatively few sessions (32) fired the `question` event, and only **496** triggered the `trigger-nps-survey` event.

Landing and exit pages. Most sessions entered through lead-form pages hosted on `api.datalignadvisory.com` with UTM parameters referencing Forbes. The top exit page for U-turn sessions was `https://api.datalignadvisory.com/match`, suggesting that users frequently backed out from this page. Because U-turns imply confusion or misaligned expectations `【521379504566290†L513-L518】`, the match page likely contains unclear messaging or an error. Returning users displayed slightly higher engagement (more actions and longer sessions), but the sample size is too small for strong conclusions.

The charts below illustrate the device distribution and the proportion of sessions with U-turns.

2. Pain points

Navigation confusion (U-turns). U-turns were observed in roughly **9 %** of sessions, with a concentration on mobile devices. Industry literature describes U-turns as cases where a user clicks through to a new page but immediately returns because they cannot find what they need `【521379504566290†L513-L518】`. Hotjar’s own guides note that U-turns are “a sign that users are lost or confused” `【591676217478393†L302-L307】`. The high occurrence of U-turns on the `match` page and other form pages suggests that the site’s navigation or content hierarchy may be unclear. Frequent U-turns lead to longer sessions without progress and could contribute to drop-offs.

Potentially broken or confusing elements (rage clicks). Although only two sessions contained rage clicks, the sessions were exceptionally long. Hotjar warns that rage clicks typically signal user frustration due to slow pages, confusing UI or broken elements `【4426695295446†L64-L85】`. These rare but severe cases should not be ignored; they suggest that certain elements (most likely on desktop) are unresponsive or misleading.

High cognitive load on mobile. Mobile users performed significantly more actions and visited more pages than desktop users. Combined with the higher number of U-turns, this pattern suggests that the mobile flow may be harder to complete—perhaps due to poor responsiveness, lengthy forms or small touch targets. Long interactions can increase abandonment.

Question clarity. Over **430** sessions included the `why_we_ask_expanded` event, which users triggered when they wanted to understand why a question was asked. While offering an explanation is useful, the high frequency implies that questions may not be self-explanatory. Users should not have to expand tooltips frequently; otherwise, the form might feel intrusive or ambiguous.

Low retention/returning users. Only **69 returning sessions** were observed out of 5 162. This suggests poor retention or that the site’s goal is a one-time lead capture. If the business aims to build long-term relationships, more emphasis on retention and follow-up experiences is needed.

3. Opportunities

Simplify navigation and reduce U-turns. Because U-turns signal confusion or broken links [521379504566290†L513-L518] [591676217478393†L302-L307], improving the information architecture and labelling on form pages is an opportunity. Clear breadcrumb or progress indicators and properly labelled buttons could help users know what to expect. Monitoring U-turn trends after changes would show whether the changes reduce confusion.

Improve mobile experience. Mobile sessions are longer and involve more interactions. Simplifying the form on mobile (e.g., grouping related questions, auto-filling fields, and minimizing scrolling) and ensuring responsive layouts may reduce the burden on mobile users. Running usability tests with mobile users can uncover specific issues.

Clarify questions and reduce reliance on explanations. Frequent why_we_ask_expanded events indicate that users often need to learn why personal questions are being asked. Redesigning the form to include concise, in-line explanations or grouping questions under clearly labelled sections can make the purpose obvious without extra clicks.

Investigate and fix broken elements. Even though rage clicks are rare, they usually indicate broken elements or slow pages [4426695295446†L64-L85] [545609647808718†L138-L143]. Reviewing the session recordings of these sessions will reveal the problematic elements. Fixing them could prevent severe frustration and potential negative word-of-mouth.

Retain users and encourage return visits. The dataset indicates very low returning traffic. Providing value beyond the initial lead form—such as personalised recommendations, follow-up content, or the ability to track progress—could encourage users to return. Running exit-intent surveys or follow-up emails may reveal why users do not come back.

Evidence-based inferences

The table below summarises key inferences drawn from the data and literature. Each inference includes a confidence level based on the strength of the evidence. Higher confidence is given when both the dataset and multiple external sources support the inference; lower confidence is used when sample sizes are small or causal mechanisms are unclear.

Inference	Reasoning & Evidence	Confidence
Mobile users encounter more friction than desktop users.	Mobile sessions record ~64 actions and 14 pages with longer durations (~221 s) compared with desktop sessions (39 actions, 7.5 pages, 147 s). Mobile sessions also account for most U-turns (418 vs. 138). Longer sessions and more page views indicate higher effort.	High – strong quantitative evidence from the dataset.

Inference	Reasoning & Evidence	Confidence
U-turns indicate navigation problems on key pages.	U-turns occurred in 9 % of sessions and were concentrated on <code>api.datalignadvisory.com/match</code> . Behaviour analytics research notes that U-turns occur when users click through and immediately return because they cannot find what they need <code>【521379504566290†L513-L518】</code> . Hotjar emphasises that U-turns are a sign that users are lost or confused <code>【591676217478393†L302-L307】</code> .	High – clear pattern in data and backed by external guidance.
Rage clicks, though rare, reveal severe frustration.	Only two sessions contained rage clicks, but they were extremely long (887 s) and interaction-heavy (26 pages, 216 actions). Hotjar explains that rage clicks typically signal user frustration due to slow pages, confusing UI or broken elements <code>【4426695295446†L64-L85】</code> . Because of the small sample size, we can't generalise frequency but the severity warrants attention.	Medium – limited data points but supported by external research.
Question wording may confuse users.	Over 430 sessions triggered <code>why_we_ask_expanded</code> , meaning users expanded explanations for questions. Frequent use of this event suggests that users are unsure why sensitive information is requested.	Medium – supported by event data but lacking external validation; user interviews could confirm.
Low retention indicates missed opportunities.	Only 69 sessions (~1.3 %) were from returning users. Without additional context, we can't determine whether low retention is intentional, but if the goal is to build ongoing relationships, there is significant room for improvement.	Low to medium – based solely on dataset; business goals may differ.

Actionable recommendations

Immediate fixes (address current problems)

- 1. Audit and repair the `match` page and related navigation links** (High priority, Fix). U-turns on the `match` page suggest that users click a link and immediately return because the page content does not meet expectations or is broken. Review the page for mislabelled links, missing content or 404 errors. Fixing navigation issues can reduce U-turns and improve conversion. According to behaviour-analytics guidance, monitoring U-turn counts after the fix will show if navigation has improved `【521379504566290†L513-L531】`.
- 2. Identify and fix any broken or slow-loading elements** (High priority, Fix). Even rare rage clicks indicate severe frustration. Review the two sessions with rage clicks to identify which elements were clicked repeatedly, then test those areas across browsers. Hotjar notes that rage clicks often result from poor page speed, confusing UI or broken elements `【4426695295446†L64-L85】`. Fixing them prevents extreme frustration and potential drop-offs.

3. **Simplify mobile forms and reduce scrolling** (High priority, Enhancement). Because mobile users perform more actions and record more U-turns, streamline the form for smaller screens—use multi-step pages with progress indicators, larger touch targets and auto-fill. This reduces cognitive load and the need to navigate back and forth. Testing with mobile users can validate improvements.
4. **Add clear, inline explanations for personal questions** (Medium priority, Enhancement). Replace or supplement the `why_we_ask_expanded` tooltip with a concise explanation within the question label. Frequent tool-tip expansions imply that current questions aren't self-explanatory. Reducing uncertainty can build trust and reduce drop-offs.

Strategic development (new features & longer-term improvements)

1. **Introduce progress indicators and breadcrumb navigation** (Medium priority, New feature). Users may feel lost when filling out long forms. A progress bar or breadcrumb trail helps orient them and reduces U-turns. Hotjar recommends tracking U-turns over time to measure the effect [\[591676217478393†L302-L307\]](#) .
2. **Implement exit-intent surveys on key pages** (Medium priority, New feature). To understand why users abandon the process, launch an exit-intent survey or a short feedback form when users move their cursor towards closing the tab. Hotjar's drop-off guide suggests using surveys to ask users why they leave and gather actionable feedback [\[545609647808718†L138-L151\]](#) .
3. **Create follow-up experiences to encourage return visits** (Low priority, Enhancement/New feature). Offer personalised recommendations, email reminders, or the ability to save progress and return later. This could improve retention beyond the initial lead capture and transform one-time visitors into returning users.
4. **Conduct regular usability tests and session replays** (Medium priority, Enhancement). Schedule periodic usability testing with both mobile and desktop users to uncover hidden issues. Observe whether changes reduce U-turns and rage clicks. Session replays help the team understand user behaviour and validate hypotheses [\[545609647808718†L138-L151\]](#) .

Impact assessment

Implementing these recommendations is likely to have measurable effects on user experience and business metrics:

- **Reduced U-turns and navigation friction** should lower abandonment rates and shorten session times, increasing the efficiency of the funnel. Clearer navigation can improve completion rates on lead-capture forms.
- **Fixing broken or slow elements** eliminates extreme frustration (rage clicks) and prevents negative word-of-mouth, thereby protecting conversions.
- **Optimising mobile flow** can significantly improve completion rates, as nearly half of sessions are on mobile devices. A streamlined mobile form could reduce steps and encourage more submissions.
- **Clarifying questions** reduces uncertainty and builds trust, which may increase form completion and reduce drop-offs.

- **Progress indicators and follow-up experiences** can enhance user satisfaction, encourage completion, and improve retention. Providing continuity may convert one-time visitors into returning users.

Prioritised action plan

Recommendation	Priority	Category
Audit and repair the <code>match</code> page and fix navigation issues	High	Fix
Investigate and fix broken or slow elements causing rage clicks	High	Fix
Simplify mobile forms and reduce scrolling	High	Enhancement
Add inline explanations for questions to reduce reliance on tool-tips	Medium	Enhancement
Introduce progress indicators/breadcrumbs	Medium	New Feature
Implement exit-intent surveys on key pages	Medium	New Feature
Conduct regular usability testing and session replays	Medium	Enhancement
Develop follow-up experiences to encourage return visits	Low	Enhancement/New Feature

This plan prioritises immediate fixes that address current user frustrations (navigation and broken elements), followed by enhancements that simplify the mobile experience and clarify questions. New features like progress indicators and exit-intent surveys provide longer-term value by improving navigation and collecting feedback. Retention-focused initiatives are placed lower in priority because the primary objective appears to be lead capture, though they could become more important if business goals shift.